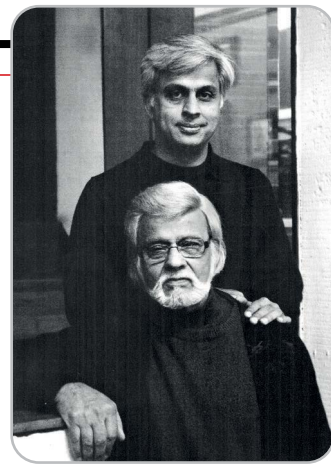






MASTER'S TOUCH (Far left) 'Mourning En Masse' by Satish Gujral; two untitled metal-works by Gujral; (left) the artist with his son Mohit

evolution of the people who call it home.

However, now, in its reimagined form, the space needed to reinvent itself once again to keep up with the times. So, when Mohit began work in late 2024, he wanted to restore the house as closely as possible to its original materiality, form and skeletal intent. "Over time, as 'Gujral' evolved, the house had morphed into many things. Because of financial constraints at the time, it wasn't designed for air conditioning and relied on air coolers, with smaller openings and tighter spaces. My task was to bring in more light, modern air-conditioning, restore materiality and remove unnecessary rooms to create larger, more experiential spaces," he says.

It comes in time to celebrate the birth centenary of the legend, whose commemoration kicks off with a retrospective exhibition titled *SG100* at the National Gallery of Modern Art, Delhi. According to the show curator, Kishore Singh, "Gujral's practice has encompassed contemplation, deep reflection and compassion, ensuring that his art continues to be appreciated by the beating heart of the nation—and humanity—that it represents", especially from the "recesses of silence in his studio". This retrospective attempts to capture seven decades of an artist whose idioms were limited not just to mediums but sought roots in the constantly shifting cultural milieu of his times.

In continuation of these celebrations, the Gujral House's inaugural show, *World of Architecture*—a retrospective of the artist's architectural career, curated by Rhea Sodhi—will be on display from January 30. ■

—Arshia



▶ ***NETWORKS OF THE PAST: A STUDY GALLERY OF INDIA AND THE ANCIENT WORLD*** will be on display at the CSMVS for three years

Sabyasachi Mukherjee, director general, CSMVS, conceptualised this exhibit, which will remain on display for three years. "It's an attempt to reinterpret our civilisational roots and their continuity, rather than uncritically adopting western narratives centred on the Mediterranean. India has often been portrayed as a passive receiver in the ancient world," he says.

While one can only imagine the complexity of the logistics of shipping and displaying such precious antiquities, Joyoti Roy, assistant director (Projects and Public Relations), explains the nuances of loan agreements, custom clearances, furniture and display cases custombuilt for climate control as well as an air exchange rate of about 0.01 per cent to protect artefacts from damage. The lighting designer worked closely with the conservation department to calibrate the exact amount of light from luminaires in the displays. "This is the 17th international exhibition that we are hosting, and with each one, we have built a trust with partner institutions," says Roy.

SCULPTURES, INSCRIPTIONS, EDICTS, COINS, PAINTINGS, JEWELLERY AND POTTERY FORM THE CORE OF THE EXHIBITION

What can you expect to see? A scale model of Dholavira, the well-known Harappan site, sits front and centre, with a replica of what could be one of the world's oldest signboards (found there) placed behind it. Sculptures, inscriptions, edicts, coins, paintings, jewellery and pottery form the core of the display. The last room focuses on the two most famous centres of learning and knowledge in the ancient world: Nalanda in India and Alexandria in Ptolemaic Egypt. In both cases, the scrolls may have been destroyed, but the idea of a knowledge collective endures. Yet another way in which the East and the West, the past and the present, reveal themselves as part of a continuum. ■

—Priya Pathiyan